MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA AUTOMATION ENGINEER | CI/CD AND PLATFORM INFRASTRUCTURE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused mostly on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and builds Helm-based ephemeral environments within a shared Kubernetes cluster. Personal infrastructure work includes k3s, GitOps, Terraform and observability tooling. Targeting a DevOps or platform engineering role.

SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Infrastructure and orchestration: Terraform (personal projects), Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access and test-environment deployments), k3s, Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems and tools: Linux, Git
Cloud learning: AWS free-tier learning, including EC2 and S3 basics

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health Software | 2023–2024

- Built short-lived environments for merge requests, with an application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Configured automatic teardown after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature reviews and e2e tests.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health Software | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split e2e tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Runs a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki, plus Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health Software | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 2% after teams began fixing the leading offenders.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (about 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and e2e test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Build and maintain Helm-based ephemeral test environments using the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; access is at namespace level.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of about 900 tests; reduced the flaky rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote the internal "How our CI works" documentation, used in team onboarding.

- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects, using both manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)